

GIVE YOUR CAREER A FINISHING TOUCH

Wondering why you didn't get a call from a potential employer, despite being a qualified engineer? It's time you enroll for a good training institute to increase your chances of selection for a lucrative job opening

■ SUDESHNA DAS

Anup Agarwal (name changed) is 26 and works with one of the leading electronics companies in Bangalore. I met him at *electronica India 2008*, efficiently handling the stall of his company. He was not one of the few lucky ones who cleared the campus interviews from his engineering college. But he managed to get a good job after six months of specialised training in VLSI. Agarwal attributes this to a reputed training institute where he had enrolled himself.

Among India's electronics professionals, Agarwal is not alone in honing his skills with the help of a training institute. Most of the industry veterans agree that there is a need to bridge the gap between the quality of knowledge imparted by the engineering colleges and the industry requirements. Training Institutes try to fill this skill gap.

"Curriculum development is a slow process compared to the pace at which the industry advances. A suitable training institute may be a good alternative to bridge the skill gap," opines Sanjeev



Ramesh Chopra,
MD, EFY Group

Expert Speaks

How to bridge the skill gap...

Training institutes look at the requirements of the industry, and if a gap exists between their requirements and the manpower available, they look at ways to fill that gap. This could be through coaching in their own centres, or at institutes' premises, or even through distant learning—which, invariably, has to be supplemented with special sessions to clear the trainees' doubts.

Initiatives taken by EFY ...

Realising that a gap exists, especially for practical training in specific fields that are important to the industry, EFY has started giving hands-on training in certain subjects through its own centres in Delhi and Bengaluru. Training is also being imparted at institutes as per their requirement. The subjects being covered at present include microcontrollers, PCB designing, embedded systems, robotics and basics of electronics as a refresher course. We shall be gradually adding more subjects. The idea is to introduce the trainees to the subjects well enough so that they can pursue further practice on their own—just as one learns car driving. The more you practice, the better.

Future trend ...

There is going to be a huge requirement for trained manpower in the coming years, as per our understanding. Since demand for consumer electronics, IT and telecom products is increasing tremendously in India, it will have to be followed up with their manufacture within the country. So, besides the training institutes, the educational institutes that are running mostly theoretical courses only at present, will have to start giving more importance to practical hands-on training. Ideally, all engineering students must learn to work with their hands, just as students doing MBBS are required to do internship in a hospital.

Suggestion for aspirants...

The students should first see which field they are interested in pursuing. And whether they wish to take up a job or learn for the sake of setting up their own consultancy or manufacturing unit. If they are interested in a job, then they should pursue fields where there is lots of scope, such as microcontrollers and embedded systems. In case they are learning for the sake of running their own business, then they should choose the field and take up training accordingly.

Curriculum development is a slow process compared to the pace at which the industry advances. A suitable training institute may be a good alternative to bridge the skill gap

—Sanjeev Jain, director, TNS Network Solution



Jain, director, TNS Network Solution.

Training institutes offer various types of specialised vocational courses in VLSI, microcontrollers and embedded systems, electronics design, automation, surface-mount technology (SMT), telecom, and hardware maintenance and repair. These courses are designed keeping in mind the skill requirements of the industry. They prepare engineers to handle projects independently, providing employers the opportunity to induct